

**DEPARTMENT EIGHT
JUDGE D. SCOTT DANIELS FOR WENDY GETTY
707-207-7308
TENTATIVE RULINGS SCHEDULED FOR
WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 16, 2026**

The parties may appear via Zoom with the exception of trials, trial management conferences, order for examinations and mandatory settlement conferences. The information for the Zoom meeting is set forth below.

The tentative ruling shall become the ruling of the court unless a party desiring to be heard contacts the judicial assistant of the department hearing the matter by 4:30 p.m. on the court day preceding the hearing, and further advises that such party has notified the other side of its intention to request a hearing. A party requesting a hearing must notify all parties of the request to be heard by 4:30.

**Bank of America N.A. v. Blanca Vazquez
Case No. CL24-09186**

Motion to Set Aside/Vacate Dismissal and Enter Judgment

TENTATIVE RULING:

Plaintiff moves to set aside the dismissal of this action and for entry of judgment pursuant to a stipulation.

Plaintiff's motion is denied without prejudice.

Problematically, Defendant has never appeared in this action except through Plaintiff's filing of a stipulation which fails to contain any contact information for Defendant and which was filed after Plaintiff paid Defendant's first appearance fee.

The court has no means to determine whether Plaintiff has effectively provided mailed notice to Defendant of the default on the stipulation and/or this motion. Due process requires notice and an opportunity to be heard. The court must ensure that the justice system is not improperly manipulated by a plaintiff appearing for a defendant, filing a stipulation on the defendant's behalf, and later seeking to enter judgment against the defendant.

Plaintiff may refile this motion with proof of personal service. Alternatively, Plaintiff may file a declaration with a timely skip-trace showing information that establishes that the mailing was effective and sent to a current known and established address.

The court recommends that future stipulations to settle include a notice of appearance by defendant with defendant's contact information or that the stipulation include language confirming defendant's appearance and notice that a defendant has a duty to keep the court informed of any changes in his or her contact information.

JEMERSON v. LIGHTHOUSE AT BRIDGEPORT OWNERS ASSN.

Case No. CU24-08429

Motion for Leave to File Amended Answer

TENTATIVE RULING:

The unopposed motion for leave to file a first amended answer is granted. Defendant shall file and serve the first amended answer as proposed within 10 days.

POLLARD, ET AL. v. SEABREEZE APARTMENTS VALLEJO, LP, ET AL.

Case No. CU26-01862

Demurrer

TENTATIVE RULING:

Defendant FPI Management, Inc.'s demurrer is sustained without leave to amend.

An agent acting on behalf of a disclosed landlord is not liable for breach of the implied warranty of habitability. (*Stoiber v. Honeychuck* (1980) 101 Cal.App.3d 903, 929.) Likewise, a claim of breach of the implied covenant of quiet enjoyment is a contract claim. (*Ginsberg v. Gamson* (2012) 205 Cal.App.4th 873, 896.) And, the statutory duty to provide a tenant with an itemized statement of the security received and the disposition of the security and to return any remaining portion of the security to the tenant is imposed on the **landlord**. (Civ. Code § 1950.5(h)(1).) A **landlord** is defined as "an owner of residential rental property". (See, Civ. Code §§ 1940.8.5(a)(5), 1950.6(h), 1954.202(b).)

Plaintiff's first two causes of action allege breach of the warranty of habitability. Plaintiff's third cause of action alleges breach of the implied covenant of quiet enjoyment. Plaintiff's sixth cause of action alleges a violation of Civil Code section 1950.5. None of these causes of action can be alleged against Defendant FPI Management, Inc.

Plaintiffs alleged that Defendant Seabreeze Apartments Vallejo, LP "is and was at all relevant times ... owned ... the subject Property and entered into a residential lease with the Plaintiff Emerald Pollard". (Complaint, ¶ C.) Plaintiffs alleged that Defendant FPI Management, Inc. "managed and/or controlled and/or acted as the agent for the owner of the subject Property". (Complaint, ¶ D.) The copy of the lease agreement attached to the agreement specifies the owner of the rental property as Defendant Seabreeze Apartments Vallejo, LP and identifies FPI Management, Inc. as "Agent".